"The Mandarin is one of the most iconic villains in the Marvel Universe," says Louis D'Esposito, Executive Producer and Co-President of Marvel Studios. "And when you have the opportunity to hire Sir Ben Kingsley to play that role, it's an opportunity you cannot pass up. He is a brilliant actor. You believe he is the baddest terrorist alive. He's infiltrated our airways. He can contact the president. But through it all, you realize he's not who he says he is."